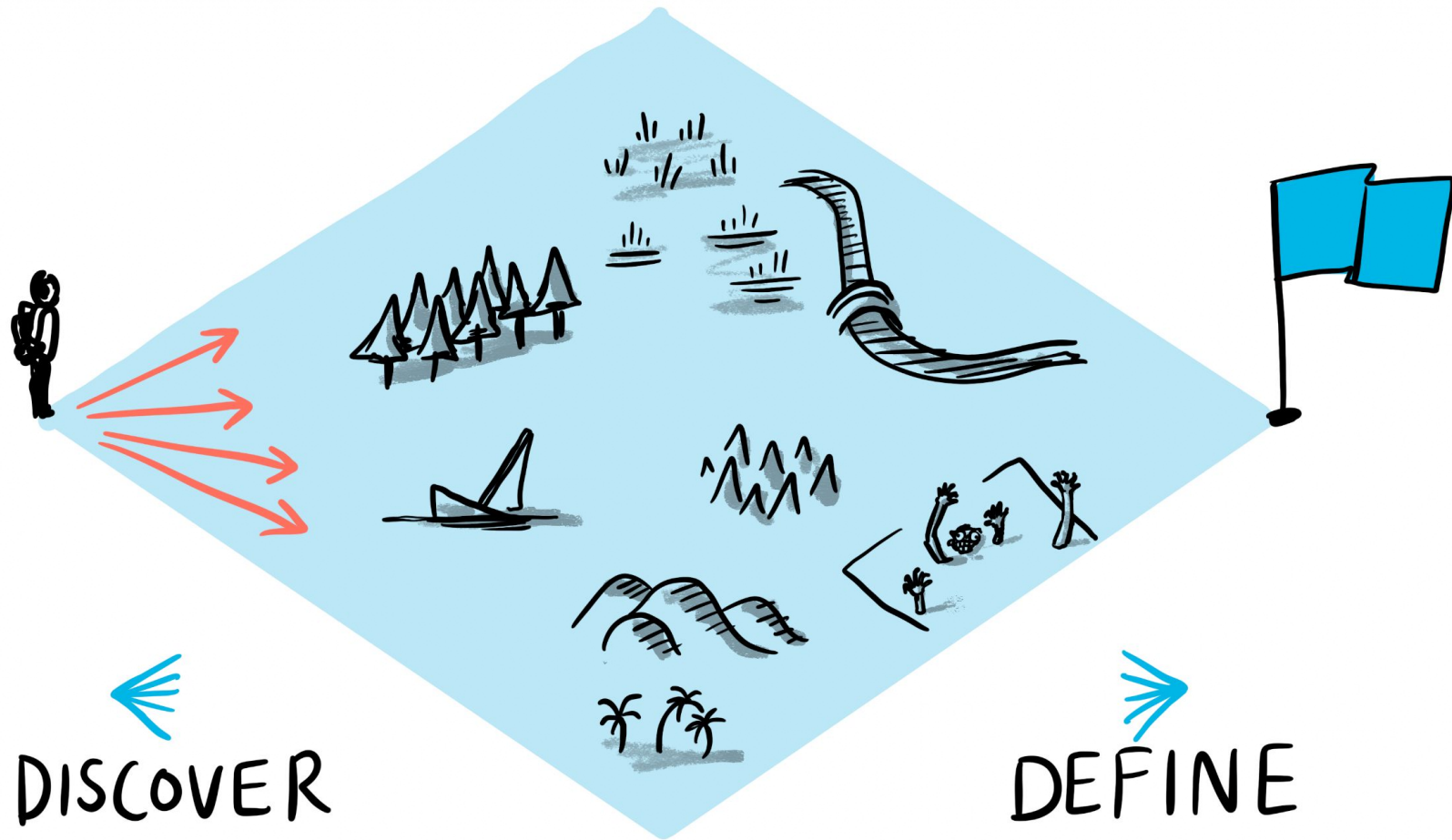
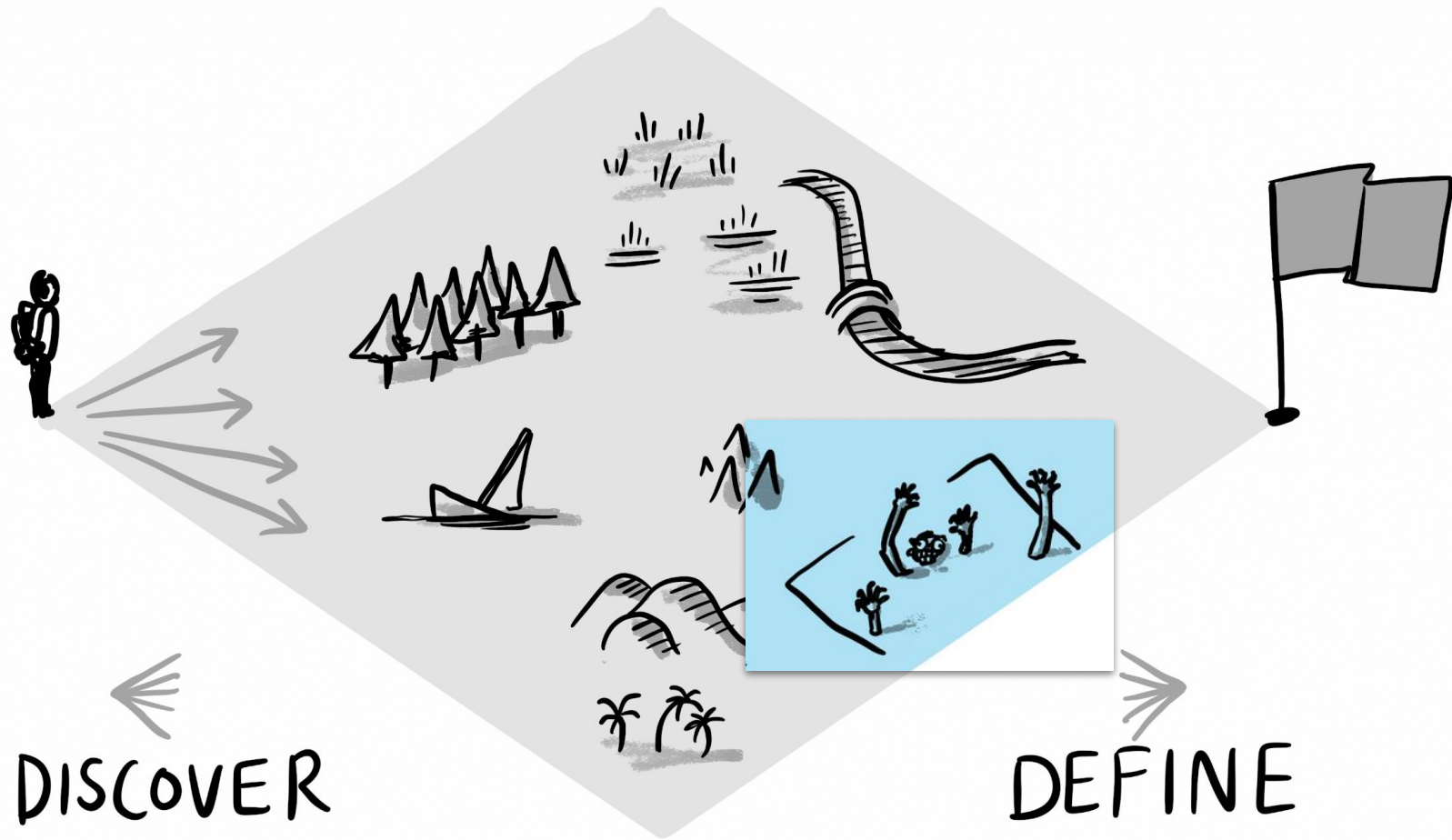


we are open

Week 2: Architecture of Participation

WΔO





we are open

Architecture of Participation

WΔO



HOWTO: Create an Architecture of Participation for your Charity tech project



Laura Hilliger

Feb 18 · 5 min read



In the [Catalyst Definition Programme](#), we're going to be helping charities use some of our favorite tools and methods to try and define their digital projects more succinctly. We intend to create clear plans of action, so that each charity in our cohort can take steps forward in their digital transformation projects.

We've written before about using [Architectures of Participation \(AoP\) in open source projects](#). We find it a useful approach to scaffolding engagement, so how can we apply this useful framework to internal digital projects?

It's actually pretty simple. We just need to contextualize the 8 points of the AoP through the lens of project management.

an architecture of participation

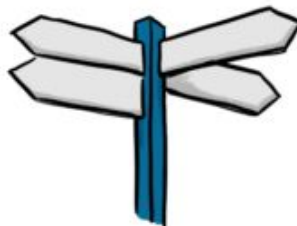
an architecture of participation



CLEAR
MISSION



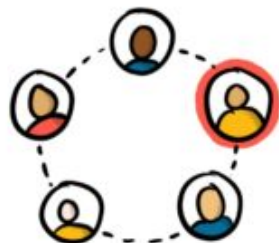
INVITATION TO
PARTICIPATE



EASY
ONBOARDING



MODULAR
APPROACH



STRONG
LEADERSHIP



WAYS OF
WORKING OPEN



BACKCHANNELS
& WATERCOOLERS



CELEBRATION
OF MILESTONES



Architectures of Participation

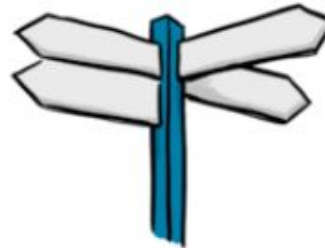
- **A clear mission** – why does this project exist? what is it setting out to achieve?
- **An invitation to participate** – do you have an unambiguous call to action?
- **Easy onboarding** – are there small, simple tasks/activities that new volunteers can begin with?
- **A modular approach** – do volunteers have to commit to helping with everything, or is there a way which they can use their knowledge, skills, and interests to contribute to part of the project?



CLEAR
MISSION



INVITATION TO
PARTICIPATE



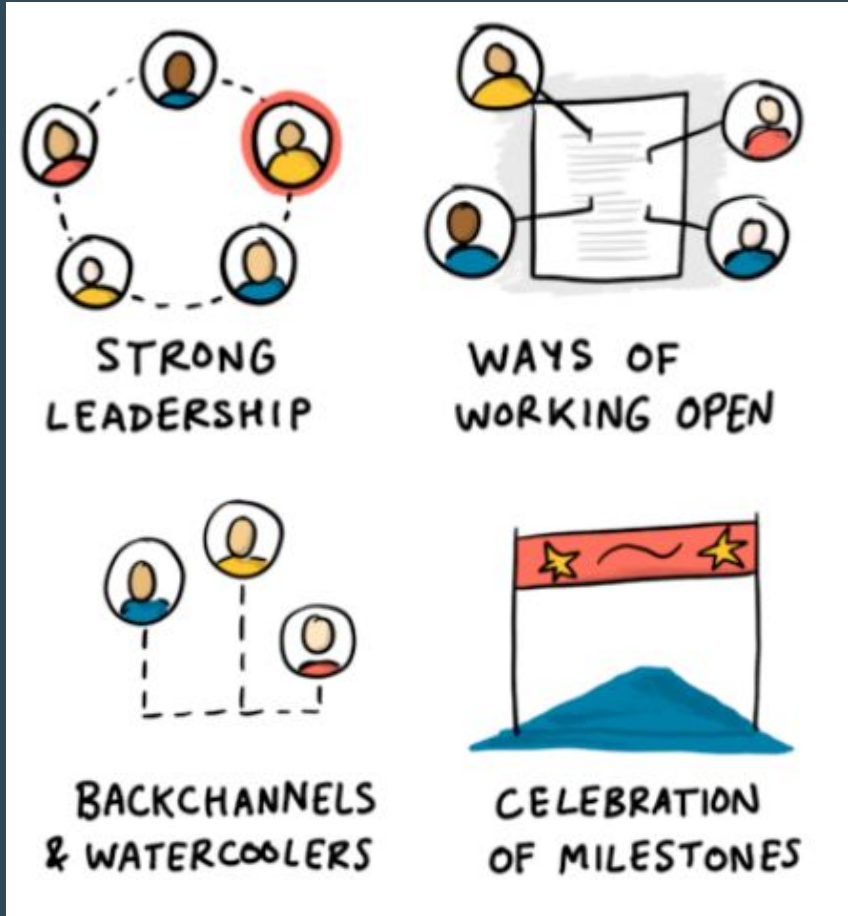
EASY
ONBOARDING



MODULAR
APPROACH

Architectures of Participation

- **Strong leadership** – do the people in control of the project embody the mission? do they have the respect of volunteers? have they got the capacity to make the project a success?
- **Ways of working openly and transparently** – does the project have secret areas, or is everything out in the open? (this post may be useful)
- **Backchannels and watercoolers** – are there 'social' spaces for members of the project to interact over and above those focused on project aims?
- **Celebration of milestones** – does the project recognise the efforts and input of volunteers?





we are open

Personas vs Persona spectrums

PERSONA

NEEDS
=====



WANTS
=====

ELLIE
26
ARTIST

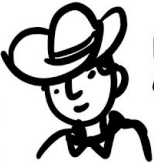
NEEDS
=====



WANTS
=====

FLUFFBUCKET
7
OVERLORD

NEEDS
=====



WANTS
=====

BOB
42
YOUTH WORKER

NEEDS
=====



WANTS
=====

SIMONE
19
TRAINEE
DOCTOR

NEEDS
=====



WANTS
=====

DEREK
58
ACCOUNTANT

NEEDS
=====



WANTS
=====

KP
29
UNEMPLOYED

NEEDS
=====



WANTS
=====

NIMROD
22
PHYSIO

NEEDS
=====



WANTS
=====

SKY
16
AT SCHOOL

PERSONA SPECTRUM

COWKIDS

GOALS:

WHAT MIGHT HELP:

NEEDS

WANTS



ELLIE
26
ARTIST

NEEDS

WANTS



FLUFFBUCKET
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OVERLORD

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UNEMPLOYED

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WANTS



NIMROD
22
PHYSIO

NEEDS

WANTS



SKY
16
AT SCHOOL

PERSONA
SPECTRUM

WHAT DO THEY
HAVE IN COMMON?



PERSONA SPECTRUM

NON-CONFORMERS

GOALS

WHAT MIGHT HELP

NEEDS
WANTS



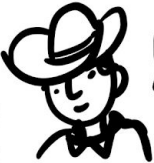
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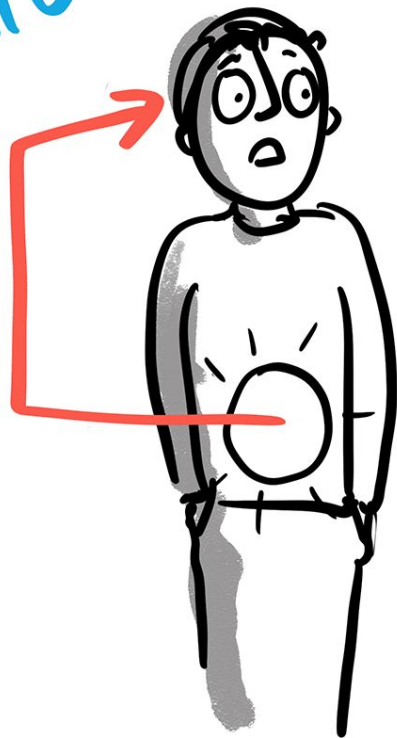
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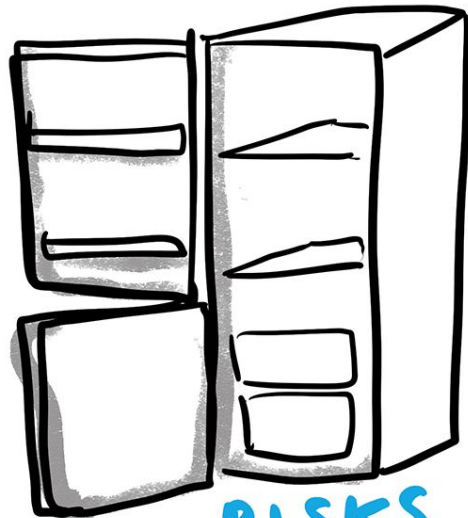
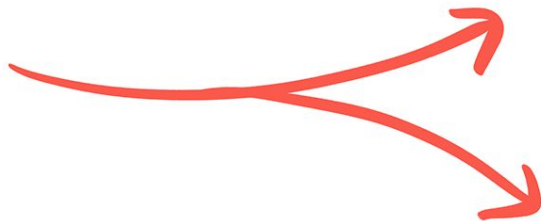


SKY
16
AT SCHOOL

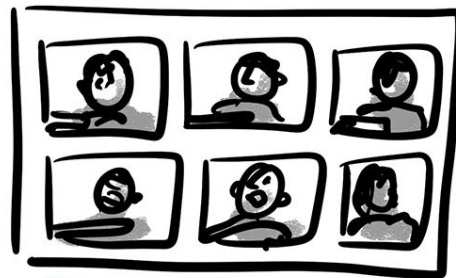
TRIGGER



LOOKING
FOR



RISKS



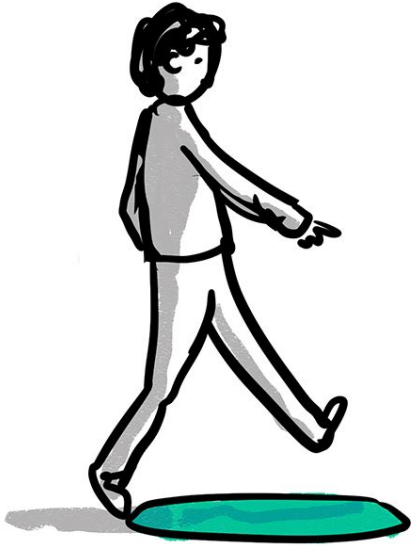
BARRIERS

we are open

Journeys

WAO

4 STAGES OF ENGAGEMENT



AWARENESS



FIRST
ENGAGEMENT



BUILD
RELATIONSHIP



DEEPEN
ENGAGEMENT

Persona spectrum mapping	Visionaries (know where they want to get to, but not how)		WAO COOPERATIVE			
	NOW	FUTURE	NOW	FUTURE	NOW	FUTURE
Awareness	Word of mouth	Targeted outreach				
First Engagement	30-min call with one or more co-op members	30-min call with one co-op member				
Build Relationship	Mutual follows on social media	Subscribe to newsletter, complete relevant email course				
Deepen Engagement	Comment on social media posts	Free/paid webinars and workshops				